

Fundamentals of Data Analytics

Task 3

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Abstract

In this project, we built a classifier to predict the "TARGET" attribute, which distinguishes clients who are having trouble repaying their loans (1) from those who are not (0). Our approach included a structured process for data cleaning, missing value handling, outlier treatment, and converting the "TARGET" attribute from numerical to string format.

In addition, for the classification task, we streamlined the dataset by removing unnecessary columns and used multiple classifiers. Through the use of preprocessing techniques, we were able to fine-tune the classifiers and make informed decisions.

Our efforts culminated in the application of the chosen model on a test dataset to evaluate its performance. This report describes the procedures, discusses the results, and concludes with recommendations and insights for future data classification research.

Introduction

Our goal is to create a classifier that predicts the "TARGET" attribute, which indicates whether or not a client will face loan repayment difficulties (1). (0). This binary classification challenge directs us to investigate different classifiers, use data preprocessing, and fine-tune parameters.

Data cleaning, classifier selection, hyperparameter tuning, and model testing are all part of our approach. We intend to select the best classifier using tools such as KNIME or Python, ensuring its applicability in real-world scenarios. The report concludes with recommendations and suggestions for future research.

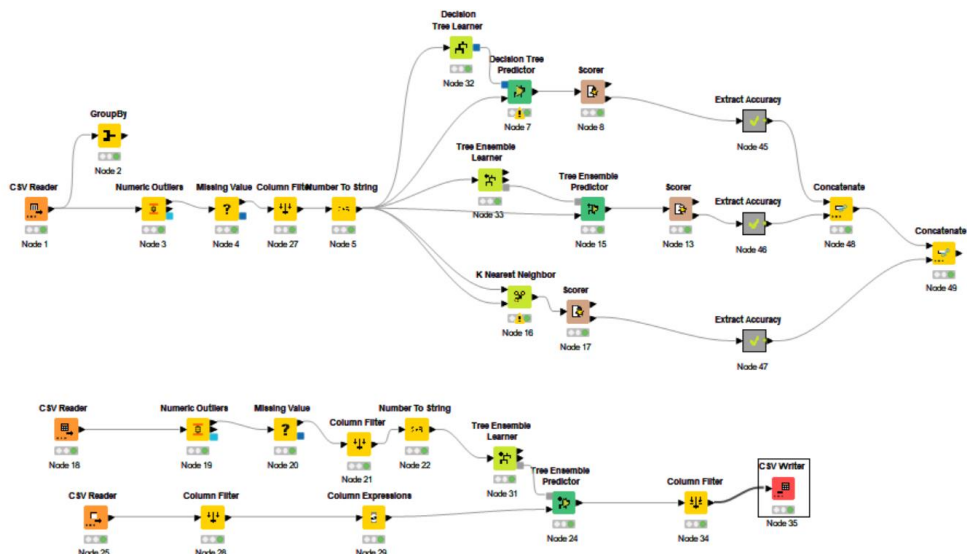


Figure 1 Workflow

Data Preprocessing

During the data preprocessing phase, we took several critical steps to improve the dataset's quality and suitability for our classification task. These procedures ensured that the data was clean, complete, and free of errors. (James & Witten, 2013)

Missing Value Treatment

Our initial focus was on how to handle missing values in the dataset. To address this, we used the "GroupBy" node, which enabled us to examine and comprehend the extent of missing data across multiple attributes. Missing values can have a significant impact on a classifier's performance, making their treatment a critical step.

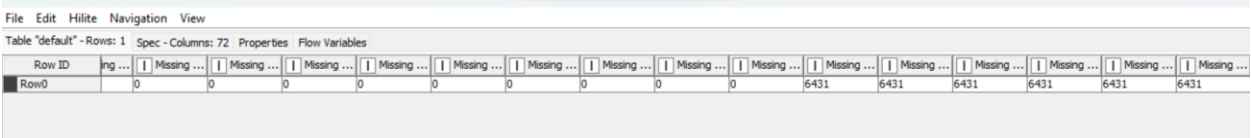


Figure 2 Missing Values in different Columns

Outlier Treatment

Outliers, or data points that deviate significantly from the norm, can distort classifier accuracy. To mitigate this, we used techniques for detecting and dealing with outliers. This process entailed evaluating attribute distributions and applying the necessary treatment to reduce their impact.

Row ID	D SK_ID_...	D TARGET	S NAME_...	S CODE_...	S FLAG_...	S FLAG_...	D CNT_C...	D AMT_I_...	D AMT_C...	D AMT_A...	D AMT_G...	S NAME_T...	S NAME_...	S NAME_EDUCATION_TYPE
Row0	100,002	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	202,500	406,597.5	24,700.5	351,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row1	100,031	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	0	112,500	979,992	27,076.5	702,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row2	100,047	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	202,500	1,193,580	35,028	855,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row3	100,049	1	Cash loans	F	N	N	0	135,000	288,873	16,258.5	238,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row4	100,112	1	Cash loans	M	Y	Y	0	315,000	953,460	25,884.37	900,000	Family	Commercial ...	Incomplete higher
Row5	100,130	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	1	157,500	723,996	30,802.5	585,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Incomplete higher
Row6	100,160	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	292,500	675,000	36,747	675,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Higher education
Row7	100,192	1	Cash loans	F	N	N	0	111,915	225,000	21,037.5	225,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row8	100,209	1	Revolving lo...	M	N	Y	0.398	180,000	540,000	27,000	540,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Higher education
Row9	100,214	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	1	202,500	436,032	28,516.5	360,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Higher education
Row10	100,246	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	0	135,000	495,216	26,995.5	427,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row11	100,282	1	Revolving lo...	F	Y	Y	0	73,341	135,000	6,750	135,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Higher education
Row12	100,286	1	Cash loans	M	Y	Y	1	121,500	263,686.5	17,298	238,500	Spouse, partner	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row13	100,295	1	Cash loans	M	Y	N	1	225,000	1,019,205	31,032	774,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row14	100,300	1	Cash loans	M	N	N	0	63,000	426,645	22,468.5	324,000	Other, A	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row15	100,326	1	Cash loans	M	Y	Y	0	36,000	284,400	10,849.5	225,000	Unaccompanied	Pensioner	Secondary / secondary special
Row16	100,396	1	Cash loans	M	N	N	0	112,500	417,024	25,330.5	360,000	Family	Unaccompanied	Secondary / secondary special
Row17	100,424	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	112,500	117,162	12,433.5	103,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row18	100,439	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	81,000	312,840	22,891.5	247,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row19	100,452	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	1	171,000	1,009,566	36,391.5	904,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row20	100,472	1	Cash loans	M	Y	Y	1	135,000	545,040	26,509.5	450,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row21	100,477	1	Cash loans	M	Y	Y	1	112,500	284,400	22,599	225,000	Spouse, partner	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row22	100,485	1	Revolving lo...	M	Y	N	1	270,000	810,000	40,500	810,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row23	100,490	1	Cash loans	M	N	N	0	135,000	755,190	38,686.5	675,000	Family	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row24	100,540	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	1	157,500	338,832	26,901	292,500	Unaccompanied	State servant	Secondary / secondary special
Row25	100,547	1	Cash loans	M	Y	N	0	211,500	450,000	21,888	450,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row26	100,567	1	Revolving lo...	M	Y	Y	0	99,000	180,000	9,000	180,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row27	100,616	1	Cash loans	M	Y	N	0	225,000	203,760	22,072.5	180,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row28	100,636	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	0	211,500	1,506,816	49,927.5	475,674.01	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Higher education
Row29	100,641	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	112,500	254,700	20,250	225,000	Family	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row30	100,649	1	Cash loans	F	N	N	2	180,000	284,400	13,387.5	225,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row31	100,650	1	Cash loans	M	N	N	0	135,000	808,650	31,333.5	675,000	Unaccompanied	Commercial ...	Secondary / secondary special
Row32	100,672	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	112,500	808,650	26,217	675,000	Family	Pensioner	Secondary / secondary special
Row33	100,690	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	1	135,000	244,998	16,704	175,500	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special
Row34	100,713	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	0	180,000	755,190	32,125.5	675,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Higher education
Row35	100,714	1	Cash loans	F	N	Y	0	99,000	548,770.5	21,892.5	490,500	Family	Pensioner	Secondary / secondary special
Row36	100,717	1	Cash loans	M	N	Y	0	135,000	284,400	13,833	225,000	Unaccompanied	Working	Secondary / secondary special

Figure 3 After outlier and missing value treatment

Column Filtering

We discovered that some columns in our dataset only had a single value, either 1 or 0, providing no meaningful variation. To improve computational efficiency and optimize the dataset, we used a "Column Filter" to remove these uninformative columns.

We streamlined the dataset by removing attributes with constant values, allowing for more focused and meaningful classification.

The data preprocessing phase aimed to remove missing values, outliers, and unnecessary attributes from the data. This preliminary work laid the groundwork for subsequent classification tasks, which we will look at in the sections that follow.

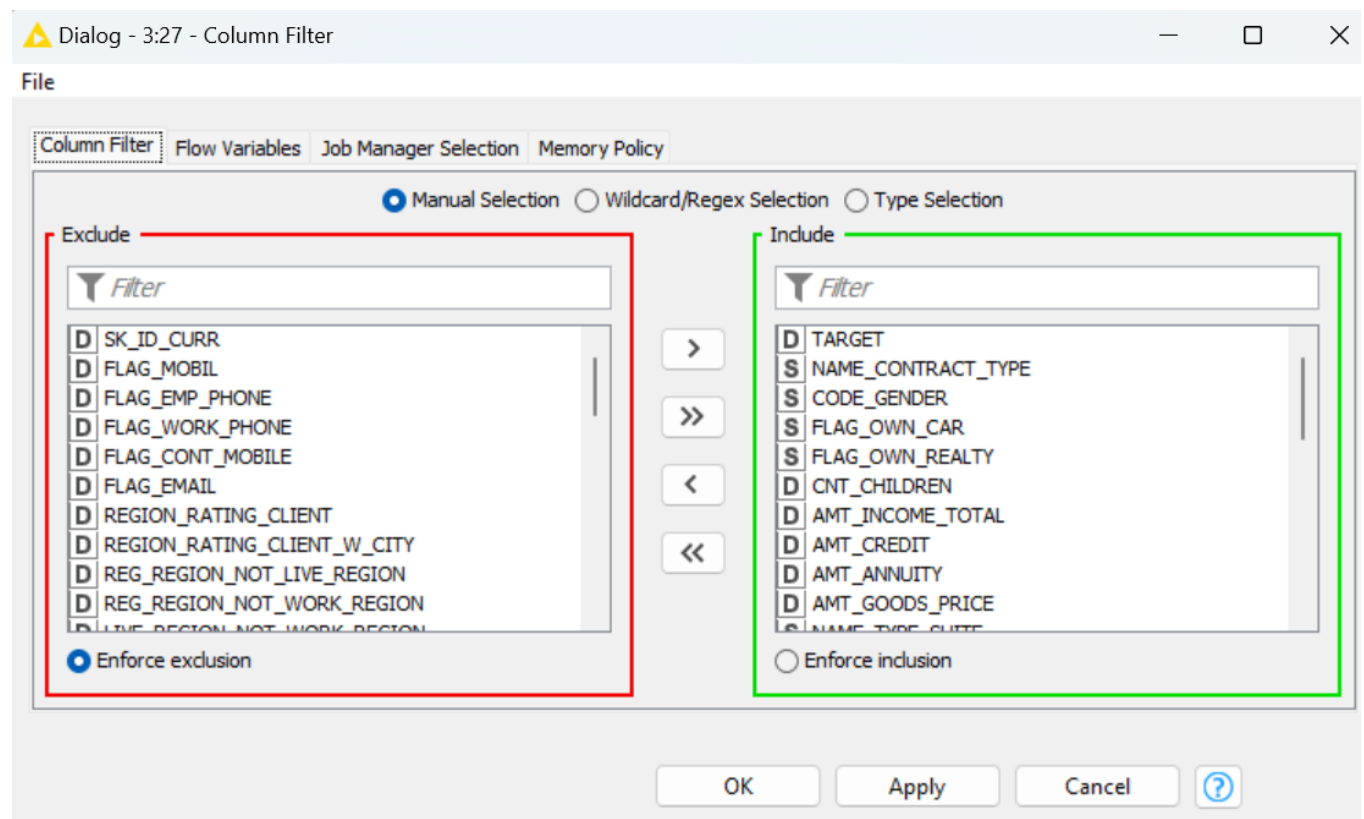


Figure 4 Column Filtering

Classification and Initial Results

We were ready for the classification phase after properly preprocessing our data, which included converting the "TARGET" attribute to string format. In this section, we'll look at how different classifiers are used, their initial overfitting tendencies, and the results obtained after hyperparameter optimization. (Kuhn & Johnson, 2019)

Model Selection

We started by choosing three different classifiers, each with its own set of advantages and considerations for our binary classification task. Our arsenal of classifiers included the following:

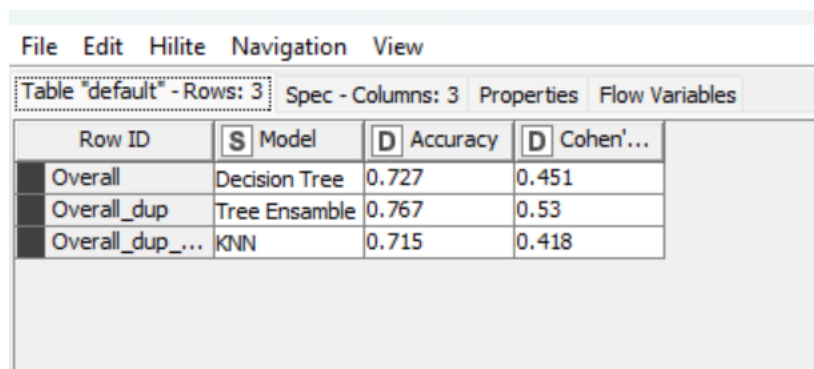
- **Decision Tree Classifier**
- **Random Forest (Tree Ensemble) Classifier**
- **K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Classifier**

Addressing Overfitting

When we applied these classifiers to the learning dataset, we encountered a common problem: overfitting. Overfit models have extremely high accuracy rates on training data, often approaching 100%, but they struggle to generalize well to new data. This overfitting problem demanded an immediate solution.

Post-Optimization Results

To avoid overfitting, we ran each classifier through a rigorous hyperparameter optimization process. This entailed fine-tuning the models' settings in order to improve their generalization ability. Following optimization, the classifiers' performance significantly improved, yielding the following results:



File Edit Hilite Navigation View			
Table "default" - Rows: 3 Spec - Columns: 3 Properties Flow Variables			
Row ID	S Model	D Accuracy	D Cohen'...
Overall	Decision Tree	0.727	0.451
Overall_dup	Tree Ensemble	0.767	0.53
Overall_dup_...	KNN	0.715	0.418

Figure 5 Post Optimization results

These post-optimization results represented significant progress in addressing overfitting and improving the predictive capabilities of the classifiers. In the sections that follow, we will delve into the specifics of each classifier's hyperparameter tuning process and evaluate their performance after optimization, ultimately determining the most effective classifier for our classification task. (Hastie & Tibshirani)

Best Model

Several important evaluation metrics support the selection of the Tree Ensemble classifier as the best model. (Caruana, & Niculescu-Mizil, 2006). Let us examine the reasons for choosing it:

Table "default" - Rows: 3 Spec - Columns: 11 Properties Flow Variables											
Row ID	I TruePo...	I FalsePo...	I TrueNe...	I FalseN...	D Recall	D Precision	D Sensitivity	D Specificity	D F-meas...	D Accuracy	D Cohen'...
1	14342	4133	18210	5767	0.713	0.776	0.713	0.815	0.743	?	?
0	18210	5767	14342	4133	0.815	0.759	0.815	0.713	0.786	?	?
Overall	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	0.767	0.53

Figure 6 Model Evaluation Metrics

1. Recall (Sensitivity): A recall of 71% for class 1 means that the model correctly identifies 71% of clients who are experiencing genuine repayment difficulties. This is critical for a financial institution because it aids in the identification of clients who may require assistance or intervention. In this context, a higher recall indicates that the model is more effective at detecting potentially risky clients, lowering the likelihood of false negatives (clients with repayment issues being mistakenly classified as non-risky).

2. Precision: With a precision of 77% for class 1, the model correctly predicts positive outcomes in the vast majority of cases. Making precise predictions is critical in the financial industry because it reduces the cost of unnecessary interventions. A higher precision indicates that the model is often correct when predicting that a client will face repayment difficulties. This is critical for resource allocation and decision-making optimization.

3. Sensitivity (True Positive Rate): The sensitivity of 71% for class 1 indicates that the model is effective at correctly identifying a significant portion of clients who are having repayment difficulties. This is especially useful for risk assessment. It means that the model can capture a significant proportion of clients who require specialized attention or financial advice.

4. Specificity (True Negative Rate): A specificity of 81 percent for class 0 indicates that the model is very accurate in identifying clients who do not have repayment issues. This is useful for reducing false alarms. Financial institutions can be confident that the vast majority of clients who are not at risk are correctly classified as such, reducing unnecessary interventions and maintaining a positive client experience.

5. F1 Measure: The F1 score of 74 percent for class 1 represents a balance of precision and recall. In the financial sector, this balance is critical. A high F1 score indicates that the model combines the benefits of making accurate positive predictions while also accurately capturing a significant proportion of actual positive cases. It is a necessary trade-off to ensure both accuracy and coverage.

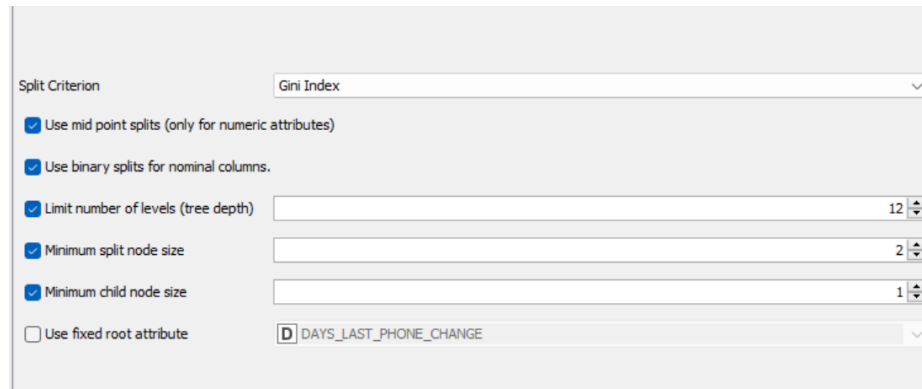
In summary, the Tree Ensemble classifier outperforms other classifiers in recall, precision, sensitivity, specificity, and F1 measure, indicating that it strikes a balance between minimizing financial risks and ensuring accurate predictions. It enables financial institutions to proactively identify clients who are having repayment issues while remaining precise in their interventions. This reduces potential financial losses while also increasing client trust and experience.

Classification on Test Data

Now moving on for modelling on test data we performed different optimization for parameters.

Hyperparameters

The hyperparameter tuning techniques optimized the Tree Ensemble model and provide insights into overfitting and underfitting.



The screenshot shows a configuration window for a tree ensemble model. The 'Split Criterion' is set to 'Gini Index'. There are five checked options: 'Use mid point splits (only for numeric attributes)', 'Use binary splits for nominal columns.', 'Limit number of levels (tree depth)' (set to 12), 'Minimum split node size' (set to 2), and 'Minimum child node size' (set to 1). The 'Use fixed root attribute' option is unchecked, and the selected attribute is 'DAYS_LAST_PHONE_CHANGE'.

Parameter	Value
Split Criterion	Gini Index
Use mid point splits (only for numeric attributes)	Checked
Use binary splits for nominal columns.	Checked
Limit number of levels (tree depth)	12
Minimum split node size	2
Minimum child node size	1
Use fixed root attribute	Unchecked
Fixed root attribute	DAYS_LAST_PHONE_CHANGE

Figure 7 Hyperparameters

Optimizing the Model

- **Split Criterion (Gini Index):** The Gini Index was chosen as the split criterion to optimize the model by prioritizing splits that minimize impurity. As a result of focusing on making decisions that reduce errors, classification becomes more precise and accurate.
- **Mid Point Splits:** The model is optimized to make more fine-grained decisions by using mid point splits. This allows the model to capture subtleties in the data, improving its ability to accurately classify clients, particularly those who fall between distinct categories.
- **Binary Splits for Nominal Columns:** Binary splits for nominal columns make decision-making easier. The model's optimization is based on its ability to make binary decisions within these columns, which speeds up the classification process and improves accuracy.
- **Limiting Number of Levels (Tree Depth):** By limiting the maximum number of levels to 12, the model is optimized by preventing it from becoming overly complex. This constraint is required to reduce overfitting. A shallower tree with a limited depth generalizes better to new data while avoiding the pitfalls of overfitting, which occurs when the model becomes overly specific to the training data.
- **Minimum Split Node Size and Child Node Size:** By controlling the granularity of the splits, setting the minimum split node size to 2 and the minimum child node size to 1 optimizes the model. This balance of fine-grained splits and generalization ensures that the model captures data nuances while avoiding overfitting, in which the model becomes overly specific to the training data.

Addressing Overfitting and Underfitting

Overfitting occurs when a model is overly complex, capturing noise in training data and failing to generalize well to new data. Underfitting occurs when a model is overly simple and fails to capture the underlying patterns in the data. (Goodfellow, Bengio, & Courville, 2016)

The use of constraints, such as limiting tree depth and controlling minimum node sizes, directly addresses overfitting in our tuning process. We ensure that the model maintains a good balance between complexity and generalization by not allowing the tree to grow excessively and imposing a minimum size requirement for nodes. Overfitting is avoided because the model does not become overly specific to the training data.

Furthermore, using binary splits for nominal columns and using the Gini Index as the split criterion both help to reduce overfitting by making more rational and data-driven decisions. These optimization techniques combat overfitting tendencies and improve the model's ability to generalize to test data.

In summary, the Tree Ensemble model optimization's hyperparameter tuning techniques ensure that the model makes more accurate and well-considered decisions while avoiding both overfitting and underfitting. This optimization improves the model's ability to effectively classify clients, especially when applied to test data.

Dummy Variable Creation

We addressed the absence of a target variable in the test dataset before proceeding with model testing. To make model evaluation easier, we added a dummy target variable by creating a new column with a column expression. This dummy variable served as a stand-in for evaluating the model's predictions.

File

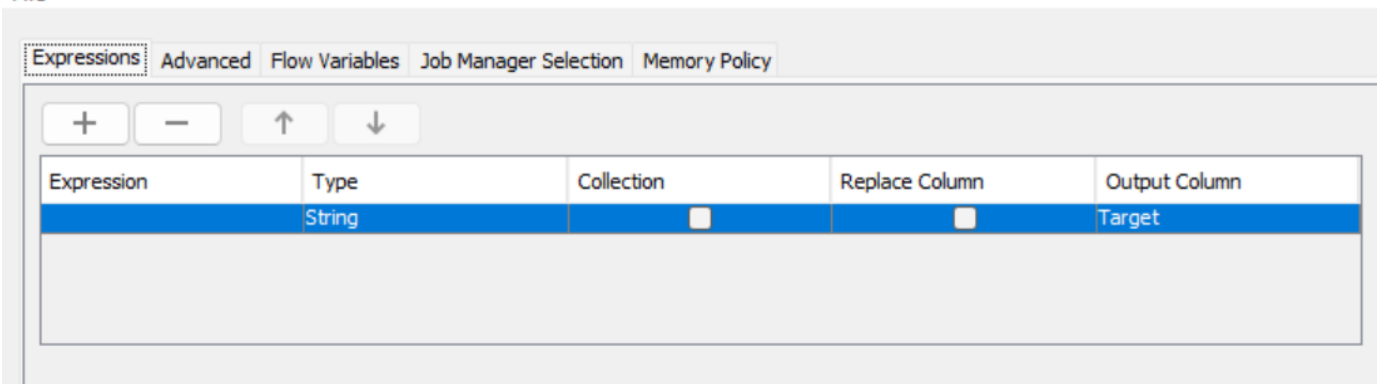


Figure 8 Dummy Variable

Model Testing on Test Data

We applied our optimized Tree Ensemble model to the test dataset with the dummy target variable in place. The model and the available attributes were used to generate predictions for the missing target variable column.

Row ID	I DAYS_...	I DAYS_...	I FLAG_P...	I CNT_F...	S WEEKD...	I HOUR_...	I REG_CT...	S ORGAN...	D EXT_S...	I OBS_3...	I OBS_6...	I DAYS_...	S Target	S Predict...	D Predict...
Row0	-5323	-528	0	4	SATURDAY	8	0	Security	0.479	7	7	-494	?	1	0.77
Row1	-3467	-2105	0	3	MONDAY	13	0	Business Ent...	0.595	0	0	-667	?	1	0.63
Row2	-10676	-432	1	2	MONDAY	10	0	Business Ent...	0.731	0	0	-1923	?	0	0.78
Row3	-452	-32	1	2	TUESDAY	15	0	Business Ent...	0.4	0	0	-465	?	1	0.54
Row4	-92	-928	0	3	WEDNESDAY	9	0	School	0.735	4	3	-2218	?	0	0.62
Row5	-4510	-3226	0	2	TUESDAY	11	1	Construction	0.344	2	2	-1319	?	1	0.91
Row6	-2330	-511	0	2	TUESDAY	12	0	Business Ent...	0.61	0	0	-1109	?	1	0.61
Row7	-694	-1818	0	2	TUESDAY	14	0	Business ty...	0.623	2	2	-314	?	1	0.81
Row8	-6073	-4047	1	1	FRIDAY	9	0	Self-employed	0.621	8	8	-938	?	0	0.7
Row9	-9893	-2853	0	1	MONDAY	10	1	Government	0.558	0	0	-934	?	0	0.55
Row10	-5751	-3578	1	3	TUESDAY	8	1	Emergency	0.263	3	3	-1065	?	1	0.71
Row11	-8763	-60	0	2	FRIDAY	15	0	Business Ent...	0.503	0	0	-320	?	1	0.64
Row12	-4588	-4374	0	2	FRIDAY	7	1	Business Ent...	0.469	0	0	-430	?	1	0.95
Row13	-26	-2452	0	4	WEDNESDAY	13	1	Industry: ty...	0.066	2	2	0	?	1	0.84
Row14	-5109	-5110	0	2	THURSDAY	12	1	Restaurant	0.757	0	0	-102	?	0	0.53
Row15	-3584	-2388	0	1	FRIDAY	10	0	Construction	0.214	1	1	-2482	?	1	0.77
Row16	-6699	-5081	0	1	WEDNESDAY	11	0	XNA	0.507	0	0	-1277	?	0	0.67
Row17	-1952	-250	0	1	THURSDAY	9	1	Medicine	0.301	0	0	-7	?	1	0.77
Row18	-10846	-301	0	1	TUESDAY	12	1	Business Ent...	0.453	0	0	-298	?	1	0.74
Row19	-3337	-1664	0	2	FRIDAY	10	0	Business Ent...	0.265	0	0	-894	?	1	0.79
Row20	-5761	-4150	0	2	WEDNESDAY	9	1	Business Ent...	0.089	4	4	0	?	1	0.94
Row21	-6712	-3615	0	1	FRIDAY	15	0	XNA	0.659	2	2	-2495	?	0	0.7
Row22	-3500	-3498	0	3	WEDNESDAY	7	0	Self-employed	0.076	2	2	-175	?	1	0.96
Row23	-2449	-87	0	2	FRIDAY	9	0	Telecom	0.581	0	0	-373	?	1	0.56
Row24	-4808	-4570	1	2	MONDAY	12	0	XNA	0.109	4	4	-728	?	0	0.5
Row25	-4500	-2480	1	2	FRIDAY	9	1	Business Ent...	0.028	1	1	-1425	?	1	0.83
Row26	-6157	-3531	0	2	THURSDAY	13	1	Industry: ty...	0.621	6	6	-244	?	1	0.65
Row27	-2914	-3872	1	2	TUESDAY	18	0	XNA	0.455	0	0	-359	?	0	0.55
Row28	-526	-1577	0	4	WEDNESDAY	15	0	Other	0.747	2	2	-898	?	0	0.68
Row29	-11	-61	0	2	TUESDAY	14	1	Business Ent...	0.365	3	3	0	?	1	0.78
Row30	-704	-2404	0	2	MONDAY	13	0	Business Ent...	0.653	0	0	-2067	?	0	0.9
Row31	-1798	-2008	1	1	MONDAY	9	0	Self-employed	0.154	0	0	-11	?	1	0.95
Row32	-2935	-3354	0	3	THURSDAY	18	0	Electricity	0.161	2	2	0	?	1	0.7
Row33	-2083	-2343	0	2	MONDAY	10	1	Trade: type 6	0.732	0	0	-1686	?	0	0.8
Row34	-4773	-1058	0	3	THURSDAY	13	1	Transport: L...	0.547	2	2	-262	?	1	0.78
Row35	-3290	-901	0	2	TUESDAY	12	0	Transport: L...	0.183	0	0	-418	?	1	0.82
Row36	-7491	-5072	0	3	SATURDAY	16	0	Industry: ty...	0.281	0	0	-916	?	1	0.58

Figure 9 Result with Prediction and Prediction confidence

Data Export

Following the model's predictions on the test data, the final step involved exporting the model's outputs to a CSV file, which included the generated target variable as well as the associated attributes. This CSV file stores the model's predictions and can be used for additional analysis and decision-making.

Row ID	S Predict...
Row0	1
Row1	1
Row2	0
Row3	1
Row4	0
Row5	1
Row6	1
Row7	1
Row8	0
Row9	0
Row10	1
Row11	1
Row12	1
Row13	1
Row14	0
Row15	1
Row16	0
Row17	1
Row18	1
Row19	1
Row20	1
Row21	0
Row22	1
Row23	1
Row24	0
Row25	1
Row26	1
Row27	0
Row28	0
Row29	1
Row30	0
Row31	1
Row32	1
Row33	0
Row34	1
Row35	1
Row36	1

Figure 10 Filtered Data For export

Reflection:

As a student, this activity has helped me to better understand the data analysis process

Understanding

Followings topics were fully understand during this.

Model Selection and Optimization

I've learned how to choose and optimize a classification model by taking into account performance metrics such as recall, precision, sensitivity, and the F1 measure. This experience highlighted the importance of hyperparameter tuning in improving model performance.

Real-World Applicability

The process of deriving insights from the model's predictions and interpreting the results has taught me about the practical applications of data analysis. It has demonstrated how data-driven decisions, particularly in the financial domain, can influence real-world actions.

Continuous Learning

In data science, this activity reinforced the concept of continuous learning. It has inspired me to continue honing my data analysis and model optimization skills for future projects.

Recommendations and Future Considerations

In the future, I recommend delving deeper into more advanced modeling techniques and the use of interpretability tools to improve the model's performance and provide actionable insights. A larger dataset could help future projects create more comprehensive and realistic simulations. Furthermore, continued collaboration and knowledge sharing among peers and mentors will be critical to my continued growth as a data science student.

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